17 I decided the cap should have a centre band to delineate the joint with the barrel. This will also take the cap to barrel threads. To make it, a short length of GPS Agencies imitation ebony rod was mounted in the engineers' jaws drilled and tapped to match the barrel threads

18 A 13mm spigot was then turned on the end and a 13mm hole drilled in the end of the cap blank to the depth of the spigot

19 The prepared components were then glued together and left to set. I use medium cyanoacrylate to save time but epoxy would also be a good choice. Once set the tailstock is brought up to provide support and the whole assembly turned to a cylinder slightly larger than the diameter of the completed barrel

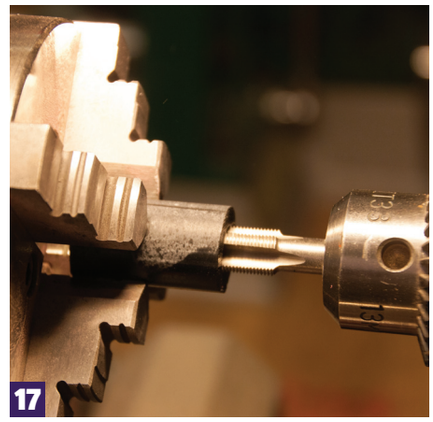
20 The assembly is then reversed in the chuck so that the excess can be parted off and the face where the cap meets the barrel trued up

21 The body of the barrel can now be drilled out to a diameter sufficient to accept the section and nib. Take care not to damage the threads of the centre band by using too large a drill bit or careless drilling

22 Mounted now between centres – I used a cone centre with a small centre point to avoid making too deep a mark in the end of the blank – the barrel can be turned to shape and the sides sanded and finished

23 A threaded mandrel or jam chuck is used to re-mount the cap to shape sand and polish the end. Here the cap end is shown shaped and sanded awaiting polishing. As with the barrel the completed component was given a final polish on a buffing wheel

24 Once assembled you will have a completely unique and original pen and the satisfaction of knowing that no kit components were used in its making ●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